

SKYLAB

Space station

Skylab, the United States' first space station, was launched unmanned in 1973. Three separate crews visited it to conduct experiments in physics and astronomy, with missions lasting for months. Skylab was also a laboratory for testing how space crews could cope with weightlessness for long periods of time.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 25.1 m (82.4 ft) long



DATE OF LAUNCH: 14 May 1973



MISSION DURATION: 6 years, 1 month, 27 days (de-orbited)



SPACE AGENCY: NASA



In 1979, Skylab was de-orbited and **broke up** over Western Australia.